

Section 7. Examination of Declaration and Goods

7.1 General

Officers should note that documents are received electronically and all details pertaining to the case are stored in AIS.

Where a consignment declared by an AEO has been selected for a documentary or physical control, those controls should be carried out as a priority (Article 24(4) DA).

7.1.1 Orange routing – Documentary Controls

Legal authority for examination of documents

Officers may examine the documents covering the declaration and the accompanying documents. The Customs Authorities may require the declarant to present other documents for the purpose of verifying the accuracy of the particulars contained in the declaration (Article 188 UCC).

Presentation of documents to Customs

Traders will provide electronic versions of documents to Customs, rather than having to present them manually. Supporting documentation such as invoices, documents claiming permanent and temporary relief from duty, INF documents, airway bills, valuation forms and VAT-Free Authorisations can be submitted through the AIS trader portal. This can be done either at time of creation of the customs declaration or if a customs declaration is either routed for a documentary check (orange) or a physical examination (red) and the supporting documents are not attached to the case, the customs officer will send a request for documentation to the trader in AIS.. A hard copy of the declaration and associated supporting documents are accepted only in the instance where Fallback has been granted. Hard copies of licences may be required.

However, Customs reserve the right to insist on an original document if considered necessary in any instance.

The following material is either exempt from or not required to be published under the Freedom of Information Act 2014.

[...]

Time limits

The examination of documents should be undertaken without delay to ensure minimum interference with trade flows. In any event, examination should be undertaken within a maximum period of four hours from receipt of the relevant documents.